

WILDLIFE RESCUE GUIDE

What to Do When You Find Sick, Injured, or Orphaned Wildlife

Keep the animal calm and contained, then get it to a licensed wildlife rehabilitator as soon as possible.

✓ STEP 1 | Does the Animal Actually Need Help?

Not every young animal found alone is orphaned. Observe from a distance when it is safe to do so.

- Help is needed for bleeding, visible injury, weakness, or abnormal movement.
- Intervene if the animal is in immediate danger or a parent is known to be dead.

If the animal appears healthy: Keep people and pets away and give the parent a chance to return.

STEP 2 | Safely Contain the Animal

Place the animal in a ventilated cardboard box or secure pet carrier.

- Line it with paper towels or a smooth towel.
- Close it securely and keep it dark and quiet.
- Keep children and pets away. Handle only when necessary.

STEP 3 | Keep the Animal Warm

- Place a heating pad on LOW under half of the container. You can also use a wrapped warm-water bottle.
- Leave half unheated so the animal can move away.
- Keep out of direct sunlight. Keep young waterfowl warm and dry. Never place them in water.

STEP 4 | Do Not Give Food or Water

Do not give food or water unless a licensed wildlife rehabilitator instructs you to.

Wrong food can be harmful, and forced water can enter the lungs.

STEP 5 | Get the Animal Into Care

- Text a clear photo, and your nearest major crossroads to **480-220-6930**.
- A brief description of what happened

Be prepared to transport the animal unless other arrangements are made.

Your Safety Comes First

For non-dangerous wildlife only. Do not approach or handle an animal that could injure you. If you are unsure, do not attempt capture.